

Northwind Retail Pvt. Ltd. - Leave Policy

1. Purpose

This Leave Policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Northwind Retail Pvt. Ltd., how leave is accrued, and the process for requesting time off. It applies to all full-time employees from their date of joining.

2. Types of Leave

Employees are entitled to the following categories of leave each calendar year: 12 days of Casual Leave, 12 days of Sick Leave, 15 days of Earned Leave, and 5 days of Paid Bereavement Leave. Casual Leave cannot be carried forward to the next year. Earned Leave can be carried forward up to a maximum of 45 days.

3. Leave Accrual

Earned Leave accrues at the rate of 1.25 days per completed month of service. Casual Leave and Sick Leave are credited in full at the start of the calendar year. New employees joining mid-year receive leave on a pro-rata basis.

4. Applying for Leave

Employees must apply for leave through the HR portal at least 3 working days in advance for planned leave. Sick Leave taken without prior notice must be informed to the reporting manager on the same day and regularized within 3 working days of returning to work. Leave requests longer than 5 consecutive days require approval from both the reporting manager and the department head.

5. Unpaid Leave

Employees who have exhausted their paid leave balance may request Leave Without Pay (LWOP) for a maximum of 30 days per year, subject to manager approval. LWOP does not count towards years of service for benefits calculation.

6. Maternity and Paternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave as per statutory requirements.

Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of Paternity Leave, to be availed within 3 months of the child's birth.

7. Public Holidays

The company observes 10 public holidays each year as per the list published annually by HR. Employees required to work on a public holiday are entitled to a compensatory day off within the following 30 days.

8. Leave Encashment

Unused Earned Leave beyond the carry-forward limit of 45 days is automatically encashed at the end of the calendar year at the employee's basic daily pay rate.